VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE SPACEX DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on SpaceX launches, Starlink, AI and the SPCX stock

THURSDAY, OCTOBER 22, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF WED OCT 21 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

A 7.8% jump, and a lock-up opens

SPCX closed up 7.79% at $159.31 on Wednesday, on 219 million shares, more than twice its 30-session average, after SpaceX "posted its first profit as a public company," Reuters reported. Analysts lifted price targets across the board; JPMorgan's Doug Anmuth more than doubled his to $500, writing that "SpaceX's ambitions are bigger than any company's we've seen," CNBC reported.

From Thursday, up to 1.3 billion locked-up Class A shares, 28% of those under the 180-day lock-up, can be sold, followed by up to 328.4 million on Saturday and the rest on December 8, under the prospectus. A Starlink launch from California was scrubbed for weather Wednesday evening and tries again tonight.

I · HUMAN SPACEFLIGHT & LAUNCHES

Thunderstorms halt Starlink 15-15 a second time

The 36th flight of booster B1063 is now set for Thursday evening from Vandenberg.



A Falcon 9 lifts off from Space Launch Complex 4E at Vandenberg Space Force Base with NASA's SWOT satellite on Dec. 16, 2022. Starlink 15-15 flies from the same pad.

PHOTO: NASA/KEEGAN BARBER · PUBLIC DOMAIN

SpaceX moved Wednesday's target to 7:22 p.m. EDT, warning that "the weather, however, may be a complicating factor," and then to 7:38:57 p.m., Spaceflight Now posted. At 7:04 p.m. it called the attempt off: "Poor weather persists at Vandenberg. With thunderstorms approaching the launchpad, SpaceX is scrubbing the launch of Starlink 15-15 for today. The next launch opportunity is Thursday, Oct. 22, weather and range permitting," Spaceflight Now wrote. Tuesday's first try ended with an apparent technical issue.

The Falcon 9 carries 27 Starlink V2 Mini satellites. Its first stage, B1063, is flying for a 36th time and will try to land on the drone ship Of Course I Still Love You in the Pacific; Thursday's window opens at 5:45 p.m. EDT, according to Spaceflight Now, and Launch Library 2 lists a 6:40 p.m. target with a "Go" status.

II · UPCOMING FLIGHTS

Starlink 15-16 and 15-18 move later

Every SpaceX launch on the books for the next two months, with how firm each date is and where it comes from. Times are Eastern: EDT through November 1, EST after.

DATE / TIME (EDT/EST)	VEHICLE	MISSION	PAD	STATUS	SOURCES
Thu Oct 22, window opens 5:45 p.m. EDT	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-15, 27 V2 Mini satellites; booster B1063, 36th flight. Scrubbed Oct 20 (technical issue) and Oct 21 (weather)	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Spaceflight Now; Launch Library 2 (6:40 p.m.)
Mon Oct 26, 1:00 a.m. EDT	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-16. Moved from Sat Oct 24, 1:29 a.m.; no reason given	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2; Spaceflight Now still lists Oct 24
Thu Oct 29, 12:17 a.m. EDT	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-18. Moved from Wed Oct 28, 12:31 a.m.; no reason given	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2

Thu Nov 5, 5:34 p.m. EST	Falcon 9	NROL-195, National Reconnaissance Office	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
NET Nov 8	Starship	Flight 15, Ship 42 and Booster 22; booster and ship catches planned	Pad 2, Starbase, Texas	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial); SpaceX: "next month"
NET Nov 10	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-21	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Preliminary	Launch Library 2
NET Nov 30	Falcon 9	Cygnus NG-25 cargo to the ISS	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Preliminary	Launch Library 2
December	Starship	Flight 16, likely Ship 43 and Booster 23	Possibly LC-39A, Kennedy	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)

Status: Confirmed means the operator or NASA has announced the date and time. Tentative means a specific date appears in published schedules but has not been confirmed by SpaceX or its customer. Preliminary means only a no-earlier-than (NET) date or month, or an unofficial target. Changes since Wednesday's issue: Starlink 15-15 slipped another day after a weather scrub; Starlink 15-16 moved two days later and Starlink 15-18 about a day later in Launch Library 2, with no reason given. Pads: Space Launch Complex 4 East (SLC-4E), Space Launch Complex 40 (SLC-40), Launch Complex 39A (LC-39A).

Starship Flight 15



The launch tower's arms catch a Super Heavy booster at Starbase, Texas, during Starship's fifth flight test on Oct. 13, 2024. Flight 15 is meant to catch both the booster and the ship.

PHOTO: STEVE JURVETSON / WIKIMEDIA COMMONS · CC BY 2.0 (CROPPED)

Pad 2's booster quick disconnects (BQDs) were "purging. Hopefully ahead of Booster 22 arriving soon," NASASpaceflight posted at 2:00 p.m. EDT Wednesday, a day after a full test of the pad's water deluge system. Flight 15 is targeting November 8, according to NASASpaceflight, with Ship 42 and Booster 22.

"For Flight 15, which we expect to happen next month, we're going to attempt to catch both the booster and the ship," Musk said on Tuesday's call; President Gwynne Shotwell said SpaceX expects the license to "include return to launch site and tower catch for both stages" (transcript). Neither the FAA nor SpaceX has announced a launch date.

III · STARLINK

United: "We already see customers moving"

Half of United's flights will have Starlink by the end of this week, its chief executive said.

"We're going to cross the 50% threshold this week with 50% of flights on Starlink," United Airlines Chief Executive Scott Kirby said in a television interview on Wednesday. "By the end of next year, we'll finish Starlink. We already see customers moving from other airlines today." He called the evidence "mostly anecdotal today," and said United's recent status-match offer drew about four times the usual applications, TeslaNorth reported. "Starlink moves the needle," Musk posted at 12:54 p.m. EDT over a clip of the interview.

United says Starlink is on more than 640 aircraft, with about three more added each day, and expects 61% availability by the end of 2026 and 87% by June 1, 2027 (TeslaNorth). SpaceX said about 3,800 aircraft had Starlink at the end of September.

QUICK HIT

Telecom stocks slid. T-Mobile US fell 2.5% and Verizon 2.2% on Wednesday as SpaceX's results and its recent spectrum purchase "fanned fears that it could become a formidable competitor in telecoms," Reuters reported; AT&T sank 6.5% despite beating estimates.

IV · THE STREET

Targets rise, JPMorgan's to $500

Ten firms raised price targets after the results; HSBC kept a Hold.

"SPCX is proving the durability of its AI revenue growth and its ability to meet ambitious deployment timelines, moving investor forecasts higher as doubts begin to dissipate," Barclays analyst Anthony Valentini wrote, raising his target to $300 from $254. Citi, going to $240 from $200, said that if SpaceX hits key milestones "in the upcoming, catalyst-rich ~2-3 years without faltering, then we see a path to generating over ~$1 trillion in revenue," CNBC reported.

Morgan Stanley kept its $300 target, putting SPCX at 15.7 times its new 2028 earnings estimate of $9.45 a share at a $160 price. HSBC, with a Hold and a $150 target, noted "the lack of historical data and guidance" (CNBC). Bank of America later

raised its target to $275 from $235 and Pivotal Research to $260 from $230, Yahoo Finance shows.

V · AI & COMPUTE

"A shot at exceeding 10GW next year"

Musk answered a claim that SpaceX will build a quarter of new U.S. compute in 2027.

Replying to a post quoting investor Brad Gerstner as saying SpaceX "is building out 25% of all new compute in America next year," Musk wrote at 9:42 p.m. EDT: "We have a shot at exceeding 10GW next year." To a post suggesting his remark that SpaceX "could rent out our compute several times over" was bullish for smaller cloud providers, he replied: "Only if they can get their compute online and reliable, which is extremely difficult to do at scale." Demand for compute "appears substantially ahead of supply," Goldman Sachs wrote (CNBC).

QUICK HIT

Southaven. Hundreds of electricians lined up at a Memphis union hall for data-center jobs, some citing offers above $8,000 a week. "Elon Musk is paying the most money in the country right now with this SpaceX little job that they got down there in Southaven," one told Action News 5. "Cool," Musk wrote.

VI · FILINGS: SEC, FAA & FCC

No new filings

No new SEC filings, FAA Federal Register notices or FCC actions since Wednesday's issue.

SEC

> No filings for Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (CIK 0001181412) were accepted on the SEC's Electronic Data Gathering, Analysis, and Retrieval system (EDGAR) between 8:55 a.m. EDT Wednesday and 8:45 a.m. EDT Thursday. Latest filings:

8-K · Oct 20, 4:00 p.m. EDT — Third-quarter results (Items 2.02 and 9.01). Filing

Form 4 · Sep 24 · Gwynne Shotwell, President and Chief Operating Officer — Exercised options for 342,170 shares on September 22 and sold the same number at weighted-average prices of $151.15 to $154.72; 2,472,035 shares afterward. Filing

FAA

Open · Starbase PEIS — Comments on the FAA's Programmatic Environmental Impact Statement for more Starship-Super Heavy operations at Starbase (docket FAA-2026-12808) are due November 30. Federal Register

FCC

Oct 29 · Open meeting — Votes on more spectrum for Supplemental Coverage from Space and a proposed 25 MHz auction. Broadband Breakfast

Nov 4 · Surety bond — Due under the October 6 order granting 15,000 Gen2 direct-to-device satellites in part. Exterra

Takeaways

1. SPCX rose 7.79% to $159.31 on more than twice its usual volume.
2. Up to 1.3 billion locked-up shares can be sold from Thursday.
3. JPMorgan raised its target to $500; HSBC holds at $150.
4. Starlink 15-15 was scrubbed for weather and tries again tonight.
5. Musk says SpaceX could top 10 gigawatts of compute next year.

SOURCES

Posts by @SpaceflightNow, @NASASpaceflight, @elonmusk and @dnapway on X; Spaceflight Now, Launch Library 2, NASASpaceflight, Federal Register; Reuters, CNBC, TeslaNorth, Action News 5, The Motley Fool (call transcript), Broadband Breakfast, Exterra; SEC EDGAR and prospectus; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photos: NASA (public domain); Wikimedia Commons (Steve Jurvetson, CC BY 2.0).

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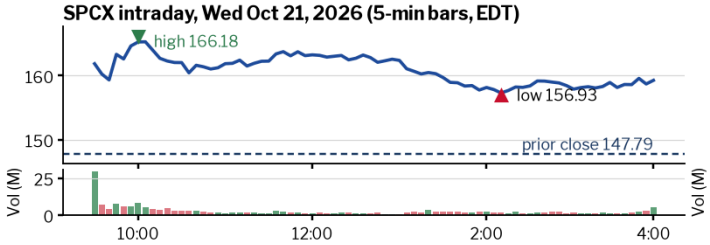
Up 7.8% on the morning after

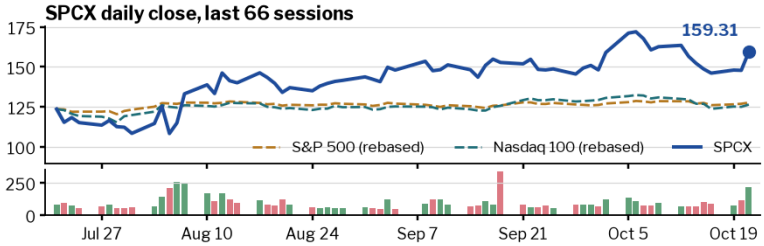
Results from SpaceX and Super Micro lifted the Nasdaq Composite 1.05% to 26,702.86 and the S&P 500 0.58%, Reuters reported.

CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$159.31	+$11.52	$160.56	$166.18	$156.93
Wed Oct 21, 4:00 p.m. EDT	+7.79% vs $147.79	regular session	10:00 a.m. EDT bar	2:10 p.m. EDT bar

VOLUME	RANGE SINCE IPO	MARKET CAP	5-DAY / 1-MONTH	SINCE LISTING
219.15M	$105–$226	$2.10T	+4.70% / +2.97%	+18.0%
+133.1% vs 30-session avg 94.01M	no 52-week history (listed Jun 12)	13.18B Class A+B shares × close; $2.16T with Cursor shares	5 and 21 sessions	vs $135 IPO price; −1.02% vs first close

SINCE IPO — low $104.83 · Aug 3 | close $159.31 | high $225.64 · Jun 16 | 50-day avg $149.14





As of close Oct 21, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 21 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	SINCE JUN 12
SPCX	**+7.79%**	**+4.70%**	**+2.97%**	**−1.02%**
S&P 500	+0.58%	+0.50%	−0.10%	+4.38%
Nasdaq 100	+1.13%	−0.43%	−2.96%	+0.63%
RKLB	+5.44%	−9.31%	−25.44%	−47.58%
ASTS	−0.56%	−2.94%	−35.78%	−50.37%
IRDM	+0.71%	−3.34%	−9.04%	−6.49%

OPTIONS (CBOE, WED OCT 21 CLOSE)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 23	211,790	228,717	1.08	70.7%	$170 / $155
Oct 26	24,823	26,448	1.07	52.8%	$170 / $160
Oct 28	9,599	21,136	2.20	53.8%	$177.50 / $160
All expiries	**2,393,224**	**2,515,895**	**1.05**		**30-day IV index 51.3**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 22

Strong buy	8
Buy	22
Hold	5
Sell	3
Strong sell	0
Mean (1 = strong buy)	1.79
Mean target (34 analysts)	$255.06 (+60.1%)
Median target	$235.00
High / low target	$800.00 / $70.00

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 30	181.00M
Change vs. prior report	+4.2%
Short % of float	2.71%
Days to cover	2.01
Held by insiders	12.73%
Held by institutions	48.56%
Alphabet, Jun 30	7.16%
Valor Management, Jun 30	6.54%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 21 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS −$1.10)	—
Forward P/E (est. $2.16)	73.6
Price/sales (rev. $23.04B)	91.1
Beta	—
50-day average	$149.14 (+6.8%)
200-day average	—
Q4 EPS est. (17 analysts)	$0.38
Q4 revenue est. (22)	$22.51B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 22	Bank of America	Buy	$235 to $275
Oct 22	Pivotal Research	Buy	$230 to $260
Oct 21	JPMorgan	Overweight	$240 to $500
Oct 21	Barclays	Overweight	$254 to $300
Oct 21	Evercore ISI	Outperform	$275 to $300
Oct 21	Wells Fargo	Overweight	$214 to $274
Oct 21	Citigroup	Buy	$200 to $240

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Thu Oct 22	**Lock-up release: up to 1.3B more shares**
Sat Oct 24	Lock-up tranche: up to 328.4M more
Thu Oct 29	FCC open meeting: direct-to-device spectrum votes
Wed Nov 4	FCC surety-bond deadline (15,000 satellites)
NET Sun Nov 8	Starship Flight 15 (unofficial target)
Mon Nov 30	FAA Starbase PEIS scoping comments due
Tue Dec 8	180-day lock-up ends

Prices and averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 21). Consensus, targets, ratings, short interest (Sep 30), ownership (Jun 30, % of Class A) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Thu Oct 22, 8:42 a.m. EDT. P/E is price to earnings per share (EPS); price/sales uses trailing 12-month revenue. Dashes: not yet meaningful (negative EPS; listed Jun 12). Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) after Tuesday's close and IV at Wednesday's close; P/C is put/call by OI; ATM IV at the $160 strike. Shares: 10-Q cover (7,696,293,669 Class A + 5,485,486,276 Class B, Jul 28); $2.01T adds 391,041,680 Cursor merger shares (8-K). IPO price and lock-ups: prospectus (424B4). FCC dates: Exterra, Broadband Breakfast.